

Gmail, AIM add single sign-in

Chat users won't have to sign in separately into both chat applications anymore.

Microsoft gives away free Xbox 360s

Microsoft is offering free Xbox 360s with its "back-to-school" laptop range in the US

Dual booting issues, tethering woes, slow phone performance...

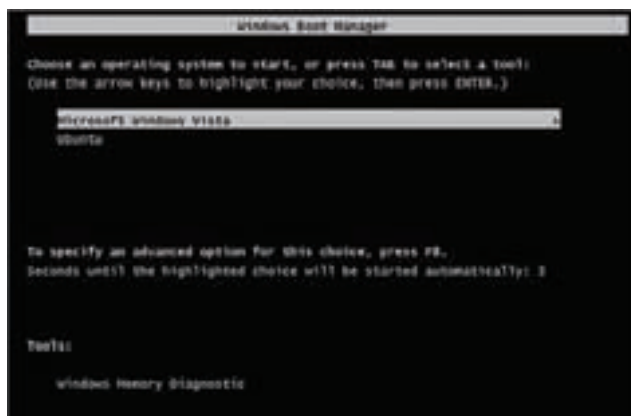
Digit answers these issues and more...

Dual booting issues

 I have a laptop with Windows 7 installed on it. Will installing Ubuntu affect any data on my drive? I just want it installed for learning purposes and also want Windows to work alongside. As in I want to dual boot.

Rawat

 For each Linux install, you'll need to create at minimum one partition, and a recommended two or more partitions. It is quite possible to do so, but changing the partition structure of the disk so often is not something to be taken lightly, since a



mistake can destroy your data.

If you want to just install different Linux distros to learn from and play with, I recommend using a virtualization software such as VMWare Player or VirtualBox. Both of these are free.

Such software allow you to create a virtual computer inside Windows in which your Linux OS will run. So Linux will run in a window just like any other software, but you'll be able to use it normally.

You can install multiple OS's at the same time and keep installing more without worry since it will install entirely in a few files, rather than by changing partitions on your hard disk.

Uninstalling Avast AV

 I have installed avast! Antivirus (one month trial version) in Windows Vista home premium. I want to uninstall it as I've bought a Kaspersky AV, but am unable to uninstall it. I tried using 'Uninstall Program' from control panel and also used 'CCleaner', but Avast doesn't show in the list. Please help.

Rebati Singh

 You need to use the Avast Uninstall Utility to completely uninstall Avast from your system. You can find that here: <http://www.avast.com/uninstall-utility> Follow the steps:

- 1) Download aswclear.exe on your desktop.
- 2) Start Windows in Safe Mode.
- 3) Open (execute) the uninstall utility.
- 4) If you installed avast! in a different folder than the default, browse for it. (Note: Be careful! The content of any folder you choose will be deleted!)
- 5) Click REMOVE

- 6) Restart your computer

Slow phone performance

 I recently bought a Samsung Galaxy GT-I55, Android 2.2 phone. For the first 2 weeks it worked seamlessly, but after that it slowed down and started behaving sluggishly. It also hangs a lot and stops working completely, leaving me with no option but to remove the battery and switch it on. Is there any way this problem can be solved?

Garvit Bhardwaj

 The problem seems to be with multiple apps which are open in the background. Download and install 'Advanced Task Manager' app from the Android

Market. It's free to download. Set it to kill background apps after a set amount of time, automatically, or you can keep doing it manually. Add 'phone', 'messages' and 'clock' tasks on the ignore list, to be able to use your phone without any problems. If this doesn't help, restore the phone to factory settings, delete everything on the memory card and start afresh.

Tethering woes

I recently bought Apple iPad 2 Wi-Fi model. I chose this for the tethering functionality. I already own Sony Xperia X10 mini (Android 2.1) and had



downloaded software for tethering, but it always says that "Your device is not rooted". I tried hard to make my device capable of tethering but it didn't work. I need your help accessing the

Internet on my iPad 2, using my mobile 3G services, when free Wi-Fi hotspot is unavailable. If there's is no way out, please suggest any other device capable of tethering. I will buy it. Operating system doesn't matter. Please suggest the best method to do tethering.

Shubham Gupta

 The Wi-Fi hotspot capability is available only on Android 2.2 version and beyond, not on Android 2.1. The idea here is to get that capability of rooting on your phone. You have the option of rooting the device with Android 2.2, which will give you these capabilities as a part of